

Social media trend generation Workflow

Overview – What This Workflow Does

Creating social media content consistently is a time-consuming process. Teams often spend hours searching for trending topics, researching industry news, brainstorming content ideas, drafting posts, and coordinating approvals before anything can be published.

This workflow automates that entire process.

The workflow continuously monitors industry news sources, identifies relevant and trending topics based on a configurable niche, and uses AI to transform those topics into valuable content ideas. For each selected trend, the workflow generates insights, opinions, and discussion questions that can be used for social media engagement.

Instead of immediately publishing AI-generated content, the workflow introduces a human review process. Reviewers can approve or reject trends before content is generated, ensuring that only relevant and high-quality topics move forward.

When a trend is approved, the workflow automatically creates a Google Document containing the generated content draft. The draft then goes through a second approval stage where reviewers can approve or reject the final content before publication.

Throughout the process, Google Sheets acts as a centralized tracking system, maintaining the status of every trend and content draft. This allows teams to clearly see which trends are waiting for review, which drafts are being created, which posts have been approved, and which have been rejected.

The result is a complete content generation pipeline that combines automated trend discovery, AI-powered content creation, human quality control, and workflow tracking into a single system.

Who It's For :

This workflow is designed for individuals and teams that regularly create industry-focused content and want to reduce the manual effort involved in researching and drafting posts.

Typical users include:

Marketing Teams

Organizations that need a constant flow of content ideas based on current industry developments.

Social Media Managers

Professionals responsible for finding trending topics, creating content, and managing approval processes.

Content Creators

Individuals who want AI assistance in discovering content opportunities and generating draft material.

Agencies

Marketing and automation agencies that manage content generation for multiple clients and industries.

Business Owners

Companies that want to establish thought leadership by consistently posting about relevant industry trends.

Required Nodes :

The workflow uses the following nodes:

Node	Purpose
Schedule Trigger	Starts the workflow automatically at configured intervals
Configure Your Niche (Set Node)	Allows users to define niche, keywords, language, region, and number of articles to fetch
HTTP Request	Retrieves trending articles from NewsAPI

Code Nodes	Clean, format, and prepare article data for processing
Gemini AI	Generates insights, opinions, questions, and social media content drafts
Google Sheets	Stores trends, approvals, draft statuses, and document metadata
IF Nodes	Controls workflow decisions based on approval statuses
Google Docs	Creates and stores AI-generated content drafts
Gmail	Sends review and approval emails to reviewers
Update Sheet Nodes	Updates statuses and tracking information throughout the workflow

How to Use It :

Step 1: Configure Your Niche

Open the **Configure Your Niche** node and update:

- niche
- keywords
- language
- region
- maxResults

Example:

Niche: AI Automation

Keywords:

("agentic AI" OR "AI agents" OR "workflow automation")

Step 2: Configure Credentials

Add the required credentials:

- NewsAPI API Key
- Gemini API Key
- Google Sheets Credentials
- Google Docs Credentials
- Gmail Credentials

Step 3: Configure Google Assets

Update:

- Spreadsheet ID
- Sheet Name
- Google Drive Folder

Step 4: Test the Workflow

Run the workflow manually once and verify:

- Articles are fetched successfully
- Trends are stored in Google Sheets
- AI-generated content is produced correctly
- Draft documents are created successfully

Step 5: Activate the Workflow

After successful testing, activate the workflow.

The workflow will automatically:

1. Discover trends
2. Generate AI insights
3. Store trends for review
4. Create drafts for approved trends
5. Send approval emails
6. Track the complete content lifecycle

No additional manual intervention is required except for content review and approval decisions.

How It Works :

The workflow follows a structured content creation lifecycle.

Step 1: Trend Discovery

The workflow begins automatically on a scheduled interval.

Using configurable keywords and search criteria, it searches industry news sources through NewsAPI to identify recent and relevant articles related to the selected niche.

For example:

- AI Automation
- Cybersecurity
- FinTech
- SaaS
- Cloud Computing

The niche and keywords can be changed without modifying the workflow itself.

Step 2: Article Processing

The retrieved articles are cleaned and processed.

The workflow extracts useful information such as:

- Article title
- Source
- Publication date
- Article URL
- Content summary

Duplicate or irrelevant information can be filtered out during this stage.

Step 3: AI-Powered Trend Analysis

Gemini AI analyzes the selected article and generates additional context.

The workflow creates:

Insight

A professional observation explaining why the trend matters.

Opinion

A thought-provoking perspective designed to encourage discussion.

Question

An engaging question that can be used to spark audience interaction.

This transforms a news article into a potential social media conversation.

Step 4: Trend Review Queue

The generated trend information is stored in Google Sheets.

Each trend enters the review queue with:

Status = Pending

Draft Status = NotCreated

At this stage, no content has been generated yet.

A reviewer manually evaluates whether the trend is relevant to the organization.

Step 5: Trend Approval

A reviewer updates the status of the trend.

Possible outcomes:

Approved

The workflow proceeds to content generation.

Rejected

The workflow stops processing that trend and records the rejection.

This ensures human oversight before any AI-generated content is created.

Step 6: Draft Creation

When a trend is approved, the workflow automatically generates a social media draft using Gemini AI.

The workflow then:

- Creates a Google Document
- Inserts the generated content
- Saves the document link
- Updates tracking information

The draft status becomes:

Draft Status = Pending

This indicates that a draft exists and is waiting for final review.

Step 7: Content Review

The generated draft is sent to reviewers through an approval process.

Reviewers evaluate:

- Content quality
- Accuracy
- Brand alignment
- Tone and messaging

Possible outcomes:

Approved

The draft is considered ready for publishing.

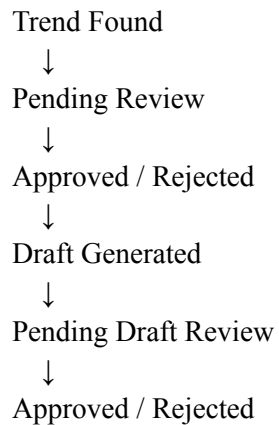
Rejected

The draft is marked for revision or removal.

Step 8: Lifecycle Tracking

Google Sheets acts as the workflow dashboard.

Every trend progresses through clearly defined stages:



This allows anyone on the team to instantly understand the current state of every content idea.

Inputs & Outputs :

Inputs

The workflow requires:

- Niche configuration
- Search keywords
- News articles from NewsAPI
- Human approval decisions

Outputs

The workflow produces:

- Trending topic database
- AI-generated insights
- AI-generated opinions
- AI-generated discussion questions
- Google Docs drafts
- Approval records
- Content lifecycle tracking information

By the end of the process, a raw news article has been transformed into a reviewed, approved, and trackable content asset ready for publication.

Configuration Guide :

Before running the workflow, update the following configurations:

Configure Your Niche Node

Update:

- niche
- keywords
- language
- region
- maxResults

Example:

Niche: AI Automation

Keywords:

("agentic AI" OR "AI agents" OR "workflow automation")

NewsAPI

Add your NewsAPI API key in the HTTP Request node.

Google Sheets

Update:

- Spreadsheet ID
- Sheet Name

Google Docs

Update:

- Google Drive Folder
- Document Permissions

Gmail

Configure:

- Gmail Credentials

- Reviewer Email Address

Gemini AI

Configure:

- Gemini API Key
- Model Selection (if required)

Troubleshooting :

No Articles Returned

Possible Causes:

- Invalid NewsAPI key
- Keywords are too restrictive
- NewsAPI quota exceeded

Solution:

- Verify API key
- Test broader keywords (e.g., "AI")
- Check NewsAPI account limits

Google Sheet Not Updating

Possible Causes:

- Incorrect Spreadsheet ID
- Missing permissions
- Column name mismatch

Solution:

- Verify Sheet permissions
- Refresh node mappings
- Confirm column names

Draft Document Not Created

Possible Causes:

- Google Docs credential issue

- Missing Drive permissions

Solution:

- Reconnect Google credentials
- Verify folder access

Approval Email Not Sent

Possible Causes:

- Gmail credential expired
- Incorrect recipient email

Solution:

- Reconnect Gmail account
- Verify recipient address

Workflow Processes Incorrect Rows

Possible Causes:

- Missing filters in Get Rows node

Solution:

Ensure filters are:

Status = Approved

AND

DraftStatus = Pending